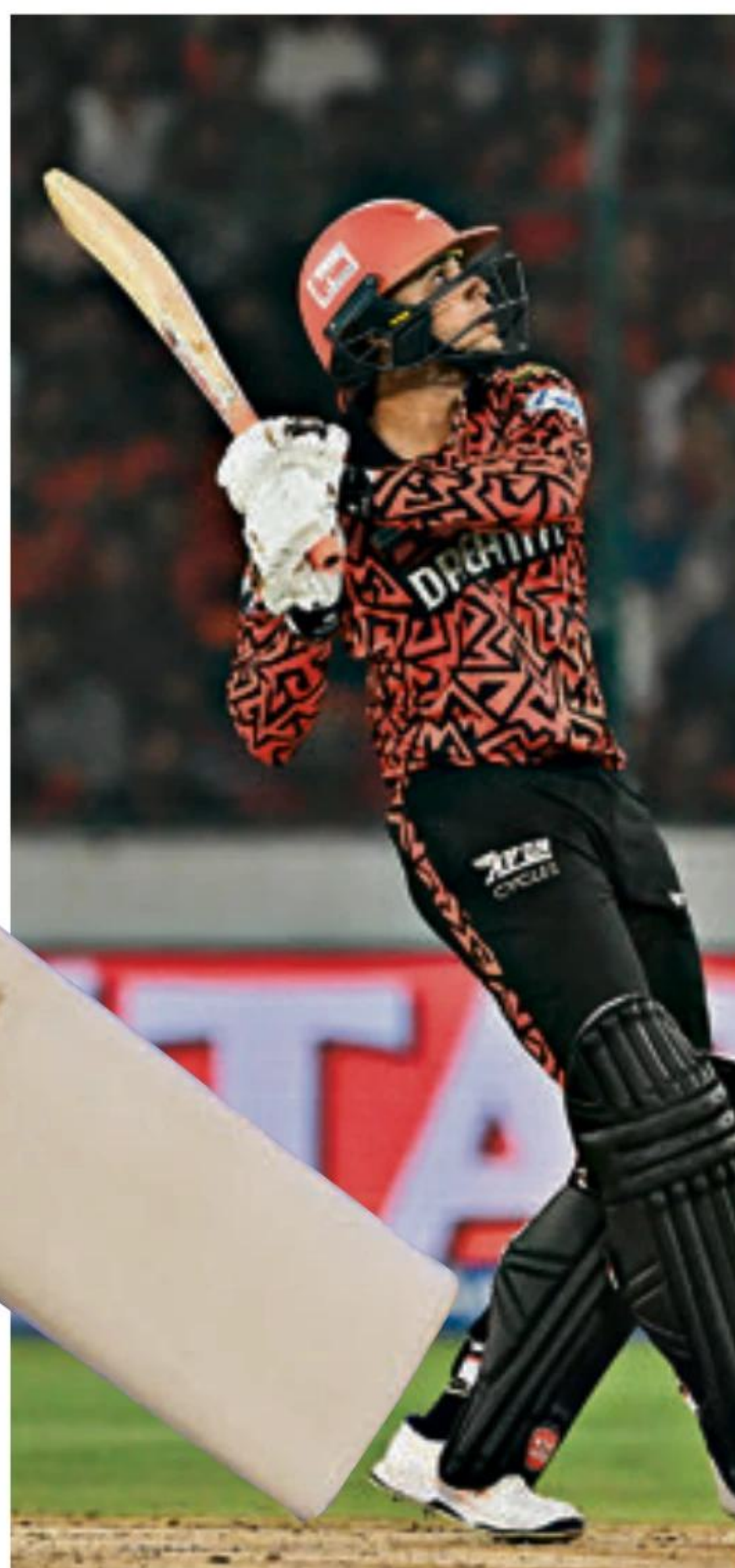




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L ights...camera...oh, the camera was still rolling? The curtain has barely fallen on the T20 World Cup, and already the IPL, cricket's most glamorous spectacle, returns.

Fresh off having faced off in national team colours, some of the world's biggest stars will be duelling again, this time in a two-and-a-half-month-long franchise marathon defined by hyper-competition featuring the world's biggest stars.

The T20 World Cup was a tournament filled with a number of fascinating storylines — not least of all India's path to a historic glory at home — and many will be wondering what implications those could have on the IPL.

A glance into the past

There is little historical precedent to refer to while decoding how much bearing a T20 World Cup can have on the IPL. Indeed, an IPL taking place so soon after a T20 World Cup is somewhat unusual, with the last instance coming in 2016. Just six days after Carlos Brathwaite hoisted Ben Stokes into the Kolkata sky to hand West Indies its second T20I title, Mumbai Indians took on Rising Pune Supergiants to start the 2016 IPL.

Seven of the players named in the ICC's Team of the Tournament from that event featured in that year's IPL, with mixed results.

Virat Kohli was undoubtedly the top performer, carrying his form as Player of the Tournament at the World T20 into a historic 973-run season for Royal Challengers Bangalore, while Shane Watson, Andre Russell, and Mustafizur Rahman all had strong seasons for their respective sides.

On the other hand, Quinton de Kock and Jos Buttler found the going slightly tough, while Ashish Nehra played eight games before suffering an injury.

Game changers: (Clockwise from facing page) Sanju Samson's role clarity, Jofra Archer's new-ball impact, and Abhishek Sharma's high-risk batting in the 2026 T20 World Cup offer enough clues into how they could shape outcomes this IPL.

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